IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 39

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Corbett	
2	bedroom	
3	214	
4	thermal	thermal lining
5	hooks	
6	9th	9, ninth
7	C	
8	A	
9	B	
10	C	
11	E	
12	B	
13	H	
14	C	
15	F	
16	A	
17	between	
18	emergency	
19	first-aid point	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	post number	
21	A	
22	C	
23	B	
24	A	
25	C	
26	first-year	first year
27	three	3
28	headphones	
29	paper	
30	five minutes	5 minutes
31	canopy	
32	particles	
33	sediment	
34	rhizomes	
35	core	
36	markers	
37	A	
38	C	
39	D	
40	B	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - everyday social dialogue

Owen Vale	Vale Curtain Alterations speaking. I will record the new measurements and lining choice, then arrange collection around your move to the new address. I can prepare the alteration booking now. Could you spell the surname for the panel labels?
Niamh Corbett	It is Corbett, C-O-R-B-E-T-T. The voicemail transcript wrote Colbert.
Owen Vale	Which room are these curtains for? We need the room name on every folded panel.
Niamh Corbett	These are the bedroom curtains; the sitting-room pair will stay in the old flat. The bedroom pair has a narrow leading edge that always faced the window, and I would like that orientation retained.

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Owen Vale	I will mark the reverse discreetly before unpicking anything, so the workroom can rebuild each pair in the same order. Please give me the finished drop from the track to the new floor, rather than the present curtain length.
Niamh Corbett	The finished drop should be two hundred and fourteen centimetres, not the current two thirty. The patterned border must stay level across all four panels, even though the new floor is slightly uneven.
Owen Vale	We will check each cooled panel after pressing and keep a deeper hem for a small final adjustment. Which of the two lining options in your enquiry have you decided to use?
Niamh Corbett	I considered blackout lining, but the shutters already block light, so thermal lining is the better choice. The old lining is faded at the sides, but the blue face fabric has no tears.
Owen Vale	We will photograph the condition and reinforce only the heading where the heavier lining creates extra strain. What fittings are already attached? We should separate reusable pieces before the curtains reach the workroom.
Niamh Corbett	Please reuse the silver hooks. The brass rings belong to another pair. Should I take down the metal hooks myself, or can the driver help when he arrives?
Owen Vale	Please remove them beforehand if you can; loose hooks may catch the cloth while the panels are folded. Our van is near your area on two possible days. Which collection date works?
Niamh Corbett	Friday the ninth suits me; the following Monday is too close to the move. I can provide the new postcode now, although the flat number will follow when I receive the keys.
Owen Vale	That is fine; the driver’s text will confirm the collection window and the address used for return. Is width changing too, or are the lower windows the only reason for altering the finished size?
Niamh Corbett	The new windows are lower, although the width is almost identical, so only the drop needs changing. Before you press the old fabric, which colour-safety check will the workroom carry out?
Owen Vale	Before fitting new lining, we will test whether the old blue fabric releases dye during pressing. How many complete pairs will be waiting for the driver?
Niamh Corbett	The booking is for two pairs: four curtain panels altogether. Please package each room separately because the moving boxes may arrive first.
Owen Vale	I will print the room name outside each folded pair for the return crew. The deposit is already recorded. How would you like to settle the remaining balance on return?
Niamh Corbett	I paid the deposit online, but I will settle the balance by card when the curtains are returned.
Owen Vale	I have the alteration length, fabric precautions and both addresses. You will receive the collection window before moving day.

Part 2 - everyday social monologue

Harriet Saye	Regatta volunteers, look first at the river orientation. I will place the essential stations, explain controlled crossings and finish with safety messages.
Harriet Saye	The registration tent is on the upstream meadow beside the service gate, immediately before the rope-lined spectator path begins.
Harriet Saye	Upstream is to the left of the plan and racing crews move from left to right towards the finish.

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Harriet Saye	A missing-person description is not broadcast with a full name unless the safeguarding lead authorises that wording.
Harriet Saye	The upstream gate closes to new spectators thirty minutes before the final, reducing movement along the narrow approach.
Harriet Saye	The boathouse is the long riverside building set behind the central pontoon, on the bank opposite the town steps.
Harriet Saye	Spectators remain behind the rope line; only accredited crews and launch staff use the narrow path beside the water.
Harriet Saye	Litter teams work after each race block, when the crossing is open and movement along the bank is less restricted.
Harriet Saye	First aid is on the town-side bank immediately upstream of the pedestrian bridge, beside the paved access route.
Harriet Saye	The public bridge stays open, but the temporary riverside crossing is controlled because boats pass close to the bank.
Harriet Saye	If thunder is reported, the organiser suspends racing and directs the public away from trees and temporary metal structures.
Harriet Saye	The commentary stand faces the final two hundred metres from the town bank, just upstream of the finish tower.
Harriet Saye	A warning bell sounds two minutes before each start, giving marshals time to clear the crossing and check the finish zone.
Harriet Saye	Volunteer radios use earpieces near the commentary tower, preventing routine messages from distracting spectators or being mistaken for public instructions.
Harriet Saye	The main marshal post is beside the controlled riverside crossing, where the meadow path meets the central pontoon approach.
Harriet Saye	Rescue launches have priority over racing boats when displaying a blue flag, and volunteers do not attempt water rescues themselves.
Harriet Saye	The finish judge alone confirms a result; marshals should never repeat an unofficial placing heard from the crowd.
Harriet Saye	The finish pontoon projects from the town bank immediately downstream of the finish tower.
Harriet Saye	The commentary team may request crowd information, but safety reports always take priority on the radio channel.
Harriet Saye	Wheelchair access to the bank follows the paved route behind the boathouse rather than the steeper grass beside the registration tent.
Harriet Saye	The crossing opens between races and closes as soon as the warning bell sounds.
Harriet Saye	Crew trailers enter from the upstream service road and never use the pedestrian meadow gate marked on the public route.
Harriet Saye	Keep the emergency lane clear of bags, chairs and bicycles throughout the day.
Harriet Saye	The central pontoon is reserved for launches; racing shells approach separate landing stages under instructions from water officials.

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Harriet Saye	Food vendors receive a separate waste collection point and must not place bins inside the emergency lane.
Harriet Saye	At shift change, incoming volunteers meet their outgoing partner at the assigned station instead of gathering near registration.
Harriet Saye	Take a lost child to the first-aid point, where the safeguarding lead can make an announcement.
Harriet Saye	At the finish, volunteers watch for spectators leaning across the rope because attention tends to follow the boats downstream.
Harriet Saye	The lost-property box stays with first aid until the final race, when sealed items transfer to the event office.
Harriet Saye	Begin every radio message with your post number, then describe the issue briefly.
Harriet Saye	The first-aid team has a direct radio channel, but ordinary welfare enquiries should still begin at the information desk.
Harriet Saye	Please complete a short incident log at each station even when no radio call was necessary.
Harriet Saye	I expect every regatta post to protect the crossing, emergency lane and radio discipline until the final crews leave the river.

Part 3 - educational or training discussion

Dr Ruth Nair	Our caption-lag proposal needs one clean manipulation. We must hold wording constant, select meaningful outcomes and prevent practice order from biasing the comparison.
Mina Duarte	The first design changed both timing and wording accuracy, so any effect could not be attributed to caption lag alone.
Dr Ruth Nair	The study asks how caption timing affects learning behaviour, not whether captions are generally helpful or harmful.
Mina Duarte	Note quality is scored by two readers who do not know which timing condition produced each page.
Jacob Pell	The two blind note scorers resolve disagreements through the rubric and record their initial ratings before discussion.
Jacob Pell	Unfamiliar topics reduce the advantage held by students who already know the content.
Mina Duarte	Both recordings use the same speaker, visual style and approximate information density, but cover different unfamiliar subjects.
Dr Ruth Nair	Analysis will consider whether delayed captions change which ideas are written down, not merely the total number of notes.
Dr Ruth Nair	We will rotate recording order so the second condition does not always benefit from practice.
Jacob Pell	A transcript corrected after the session would not recreate the real-time experience, so all outcomes are captured immediately.
Dr Ruth Nair	The interview asks about strategies, such as switching attention between slides and captions, without implying that one strategy is correct.

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Mina Duarte	Could we add eye tracking? On reflection, calibration could consume too much of each session in a project this small.
Mina Duarte	Alongside the comprehension test, we will score the quality of participants' notes using a blind rubric.
Dr Ruth Nair	The scoring rubric rewards accurate ideas and useful organisation rather than the sheer number of words written.
Mina Duarte	The team will report missing data caused by equipment failure separately from blank responses supplied by participants.
Jacob Pell	I will log pauses or restarts separately, since replaying material would change the one-pass comparison we intend to study.
Jacob Pell	Concentration ratings are useful background data, but they cannot be the only outcome because they are subjective.
Mina Duarte	Students with hearing needs are not excluded, but the team will record preferred access arrangements and avoid treating them as a single group.
Jacob Pell	I will synchronise caption and audio tracks using a visible marker before exporting the files for the experiment.
Dr Ruth Nair	Participants see a neutral screen during the final questionnaire, preventing one caption condition from remaining visible as they answer.
Dr Ruth Nair	Recruit first-year students so experience with recorded university lectures is reasonably similar.
Jacob Pell	Mina will prepare the delayed files, I will randomise the sequence, and Dr Nair will check that the comparison changes only timing.
Dr Ruth Nair	Mina checks each delayed file from beginning to end because a correct opening does not guarantee stable timing later.
Mina Duarte	The consent process explains that reading speed is not being diagnosed and individual scores will not be returned as an ability test.
Mina Duarte	The delayed condition will trail the speech by three seconds; five seconds felt obviously disruptive in the pilot.
Dr Ruth Nair	One recording concerns an unfamiliar geological process and the other a historical research method, reducing direct overlap in background knowledge.
Mina Duarte	Dr Nair rejects a live internet stream, which could introduce buffering delays unrelated to the planned caption condition.
Jacob Pell	Closed-back headphones will reduce variation from corridor noise.
Mina Duarte	Caption wording will be identical in both conditions; only the time at which each caption appears will change.
Jacob Pell	The testing room uses identical screens, and automatic caption controls are disabled so participants cannot alter presentation settings.
Dr Ruth Nair	Participants will take notes on paper, avoiding differences in laptop notification settings.

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Jacob Pell	The three-second lag was chosen because pilot students noticed disruption without abandoning the caption stream entirely.
Jacob Pell	Participants keep the same paper size and pen colour so page images do not reveal the condition to scorers.
Dr Ruth Nair	A brief practice clip teaches the note-taking procedure but contains no material from either scored lecture.
Jacob Pell	A second pilot checks whether the paper note sheet offers enough space without encouraging unusually detailed transcription.
Mina Duarte	The final interview will last five minutes and ask when participants noticed the delay.
Dr Ruth Nair	Comprehension questions target ideas stated in speech rather than incidental details visible on a slide.
Mina Duarte	Students answer comprehension items before the interview to prevent later discussion from changing their recorded understanding.
Jacob Pell	The caption study now isolates timing, combines comprehension with blinded note scoring and documents how participants adapt their attention.

Part 4 - academic monologue

Professor Nia Mercer	Today I will use a coastal-restoration case study from our methods course. Its meadow records and carbon figures belong to the exercise; focus on how the accounting works.
Professor Nia Mercer	In the first sample, the leaf canopy slows water near the seabed, allowing material to settle.
Professor Nia Mercer	Carbon capture, burial and long-term storage describe related but distinct stages, and using the words interchangeably creates misleading estimates.
Professor Nia Mercer	Protection claims should distinguish avoided loss from new burial, because both matter but answer different management questions.
Professor Nia Mercer	Meadows trap fine particles carried from elsewhere as well as material produced inside the habitat.
Professor Nia Mercer	Leaves reduce current speed, allowing particles to settle, while below-ground structures make the surface less easily disturbed.
Professor Nia Mercer	Burial does not guarantee permanence because oxygen exposure, erosion or disturbance can return stored carbon to active cycles.
Professor Nia Mercer	Bulk density measurements convert concentration into stock per area; using concentration alone can misrepresent loosely packed layers.
Professor Nia Mercer	Long-term monitoring reveals whether early gains persist after storms, plant turnover and changes in surrounding land use.
Professor Nia Mercer	In this dataset, most long-term carbon lies in sediment, not visible leaves.
Professor Nia Mercer	The next section separates sources: some buried carbon comes from the meadow, while some arrives from rivers, nearby habitats or offshore water.

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Professor Nia Mercer	Fine sediment can contain more organic material than coarse sand, so changing grain size across sites may influence concentration estimates.
Professor Nia Mercer	The survey team records meadow boundaries because expanding the sampled area would raise estimated stock without changing the study meadow.
Professor Nia Mercer	Public summaries should avoid converting uncertain stocks directly into guaranteed climate benefits without showing the assumptions used.
Professor Nia Mercer	In our course meadow, roots and rhizomes form a network that helps stabilise the seabed.
Professor Nia Mercer	A large existing stock does not reveal how quickly it formed or how much would remain if the meadow were damaged.
Professor Nia Mercer	Below ground, roots and rhizomes contribute material directly while binding deposits against ordinary current movement.
Professor Nia Mercer	For the methods workshop, compare two independent dating estimates and flag any disagreement rather than accepting one isolated date.
Professor Nia Mercer	Root, rhizome and leaf tissues differ in chemistry, so their contributions to sediment carbon cannot be treated as identical.
Professor Nia Mercer	Even careful carbon estimates sit alongside other restoration outcomes, including habitat, water quality and shoreline stability.
Professor Nia Mercer	We now examine sampling. A sediment core provides a vertical sequence for analysis by depth.
Professor Nia Mercer	Cores provide depth profiles, but compression, mixing by animals and dating uncertainty complicate interpretation.
Professor Nia Mercer	Imported material may already be old, so not all buried carbon counts as newly captured.
Professor Nia Mercer	Boat anchoring and dredging disturb sediment directly, whereas nutrient stress may weaken vegetation before erosion becomes visible.
Professor Nia Mercer	The team uses coded chemical markers to estimate when the sampled layers accumulated.
Professor Nia Mercer	Storms can remove vegetation and expose sediment, potentially remobilising material that had been buried.
Professor Nia Mercer	A core is divided into depth intervals so concentration, particle size and potential age markers can be compared vertically.
Professor Nia Mercer	A reference meadow helps reveal natural year-to-year variation that could otherwise be mistaken for a restoration effect.
Professor Nia Mercer	Restoration plots can fail unevenly, so averaging planted and bare patches requires a transparent area-weighting method.
Professor Nia Mercer	Carbon produced by the seagrass itself is classified as local plant material.
Professor Nia Mercer	For evaluation, the study compares pre-intervention measurements with reference sites.

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Professor Nia Mercer	Restored plants may stabilise sediment before measurable carbon accumulation becomes large, so ecological recovery and storage rates need separate reporting.
Professor Nia Mercer	A nearby unvegetated site is informative but may differ in current exposure or sediment source from the restored meadow.
Professor Nia Mercer	Particles washed from the catchment belong to the imported terrestrial category.
Professor Nia Mercer	The report includes uncertainty ranges because its short monitoring period cannot demonstrate permanent storage.
Professor Nia Mercer	Damage can expose deep layers rapidly, demonstrating that stock protection may matter as much as annual sequestration.
Professor Nia Mercer	In the field plan, cores follow a pre-set sampling grid and any disturbance caused by sampling is recorded.
Professor Nia Mercer	In the storm record, carbon lost after a severe event is recorded as remobilised material because its burial has been reversed.
Professor Nia Mercer	Seagrass photosynthesis fixes carbon into plant tissue, but much of that visible tissue is short-lived and may be consumed or exported.
Professor Nia Mercer	Management estimates distinguish gross accumulation from additional storage attributable to the intervention.
Professor Nia Mercer	For the final reporting stage, the account specifies depth because a shallow survey cannot be compared directly with a much deeper historical core.
Professor Nia Mercer	Additional storage after restoration is the restoration gain, calculated against a credible baseline rather than the total stock.
Professor Nia Mercer	The dense canopy reduces turbulence near the bed, creating conditions in which suspended mineral and organic particles can settle.
Professor Nia Mercer	The report states its measurement boundaries, origin assumptions and the period over which continued burial is observed.
Professor Nia Mercer	Laboratory analysis can identify broad material sources, although mixed origins rarely separate into perfectly distinct categories.
Professor Nia Mercer	For the restoration scenario, report source, depth, baseline and permanence instead of equating existing sediment stock with a guaranteed new benefit.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	v	
2	ii	
3	viii	
4	iv	
5	i	
6	vii	
7	iii	
8	heaps	
9	wheels	
10	stones	
11	slurry	
12	intake	
13	maintenance	
14	FALSE	
15	FALSE	
16	FALSE	
17	FALSE	
18	TRUE	
19	NOT GIVEN	
20	FALSE	
21	E	
22	B	
23	H	
24	D	
25	F	
26	C	
27	A	
28	B	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	C	
30	A	
31	C	
32	NO	
33	YES	
34	NO	
35	NO	
36	coincidence	
37	materials	
38	network	
39	relationships	
40	sponsor	

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